

MONTHLY CURRENT AFFAIRS

JANUARY 2026

For All India Competitive Examinations

SSC | UPSC | Railway | Banking | State PSC | Defence

SECTIONS COVERED:

1. National Affairs & Government Schemes
2. International Affairs
3. Defence & Security
4. Economy & Banking
5. Science & Technology
6. Sports
7. Awards & Honours
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DISCLAIMER: This compilation is based on publicly available information.
Verify all facts from official sources before relying on them for exams.

NATIONAL AFFAIRS & GOVERNMENT SCHEMES

Republic Day 2026

- > India celebrated its 77th Republic Day on January 26, 2026 with the theme '150 Years of Vande Mataram'.
- > The Beating Retreat ceremony was held on January 29, 2026 at Vijay Chowk, New Delhi.

Government Initiatives

- > Cabinet approved continuation of Atal Pension Yojana for FY 2026-27.
- > Equity infusion for SIDBI approved to support MSME sector.
- > Launch of #SkilltheNation challenge by the Government.
- > Smart fishing harbor project approved by the Cabinet.
- > Grand International Exposition on Buddhist relics inaugurated.
- > Indian Lighthouse Festival held in January 2026.
- > First Vande Bharat Sleeper Train introduced.
- > Economic Survey 2025-26 presented on January 29, projecting GDP growth at 7.4% for FY26.
- > Budget Session of Parliament commenced on January 28, 2026.

INTERNATIONAL AFFAIRS

Key Developments

- > BRICS expansion and 2026 summit discussions held in January.
- > India-Germany relations strengthened with bilateral meetings.
- > India and Israel elevated bilateral ties.

DEFENCE & SECURITY

Military Exercises

- > Exercise Desert Cyclone-II: Joint military exercise between India and the UAE (January 2026).
- > BRICS joint military drills conducted in January 2026.

Key Appointments

- > Air Marshal Nagesh Kapoor appointed as Vice Chief of Air Staff.
- > CDS General Anil Chauhan continued in his extended term.

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

ISRO

- > PSLV-C62 mission launched on January 12, 2026 from Sriharikota carrying 16 satellites.
- > Primary payload: DRDO's EOS-N1 (Anvesha) strategic satellite.
- > Mission failed due to anomaly in the third stage of the launch vehicle.
- > This was India's first space mission of 2026 - ended in failure.
- > The mission included India's first orbital AI-image laboratory concept.

Other Developments

- > India's first AI Clinic inaugurated in January 2026.
- > India's first bullet train project progress updates announced.

SPORTS

Cricket

- > ICC T20 World Cup 2026 began in India (February-March final phase).

Other Sports

- > India's achievements in global sports rankings noted.

AWARDS & HONOURS

Padma Awards 2026 (Announced on Republic Day, Jan 25)

- > Total 131 Padma Awards approved for 2026 (5 Padma Vibhushan + 13 Padma Bhushan + 113 Padma Shri).
- > Padma Vibhushan: Dharmendra Singh Deol (posthumous, Art), V S Achuthanandan (posthumous, Public Affairs), N. Rajam (Music), Piyush Pandey (Literature), Uday Kotak (Trade & Industry).
- > Notable Padma Bhushan: Mammooty (Art), Alka Yagnik (Art).
- > Notable Padma Shri: Rohit Sharma (Sports), R Madhavan (Art), Harmanpreet Kaur (Sports).

APPOINTMENTS

- > Air Marshal Nagesh Kapoor - Vice Chief of Air Staff.
- > Justice Revati Mohite Dere - First woman Chief Justice of Meghalaya High Court.

IMPORTANT DAYS IN JANUARY 2026

- > January 1 - Global Family Day
- > January 4 - World Braille Day
- > January 9 - NRI Day (Pravasi Bharatiya Divas)
- > January 10 - World Hindi Day
- > January 12 - National Youth Day (Swami Vivekananda Jayanti)
- > January 13 - Lohri
- > January 14 - Makar Sankranti / Pongal / Magh Bihu
- > January 15 - Indian Army Day
- > January 23 - Netaji Subhash Chandra Bose Jayanti (Parakram Diwas)
- > January 24 - National Girl Child Day
- > January 25 - National Voters' Day / National Tourism Day
- > January 26 - Republic Day
- > January 30 - Martyrs' Day (Shaheed Diwas) / World Leprosy Day